Professional, Legal and Ethical Issues

The Moderated Learning Management System (MLMS) raises professional, legal and ethical responsibilities because it handles learners' personal information, assignment submissions and assessment results.

Data protection: The system must protect learners' personal information and process it only for legitimate educational purposes. In Lesotho, the relevant legislation includes the Data Protection Act, 2011 (Act No. 5 of 2012). The design supports privacy through user authentication, role-based access control and limiting access to information according to users' responsibilities. Data collection and retention should also be limited to legitimate needs.

Security of assessment records: Assignment submissions, marks and deadlines must be protected against unauthorised access and modification. The design uses authentication, role-based permissions and controlled database operations to help protect these records. Appropriate backups, secure storage and audit logging should also be used where implemented to preserve data integrity and accountability.

Accessibility: The system should provide equal access to learners with disabilities. The interface should use readable text, clear navigation, meaningful labels, sufficient colour contrast and keyboard accessibility. Assignment information should be presented in accessible formats where practical. Accessibility testing is necessary to confirm that these measures work for users with different needs.

Fairness of late penalties: Late-penalty rules must be transparent and applied consistently to all learners in equivalent circumstances. The system uses a defined penalty strategy to calculate penalties based on submission timestamps and assignment deadlines. Boundary tests should verify submissions before, at and after the deadline. Approved extensions and exceptional circumstances should be handled according to institutional policy.

Overall, the MLMS design aims to protect privacy, maintain assessment integrity, support accessibility and ensure consistent treatment of

learners. These design measures support responsible software development, but full legal compliance, security and accessibility must be verified through implementation and testing.